hundred and twenty-four feet by thirty-one). On each side of this room or hall are three stone galleries, two feet eight inches wide, with iron rails. The chambers are numbered, amounting to one hundred and twenty: these are all similar, nine feet two inches by eight feet two; they have one window outward, three feet by two; and one towards the great room, two feet five inches by one foot five:[1] they are furnished with a bed and bedding, a stool, and a vault. In the infirmary, and the dormitory for boys, as well as in the great hall, there were stone sinks and water laid on. Near the end of the room there is an altar with a cupola over it. On one side of the altar is the dormitory for boys, and on the other the infirmary. And all together make the figure of a cross, which is the form of many hospitals in Italy and other Roman Catholic countries.

There were near three hundred prisoners in this house; twenty of whom were chained to two benches in the dormitory, but at the same time employed in spinning, or making and mending clothes. Adjoining to the workrooms there are two or three rooms for warehouses. All the prisoners work in irons.

"GENOA HOSPITAL. The benefactors to this hospital are distinguished by the different postures and attitudes in which their statues are placed, in the wards, and on the staircase according to the different sums which they have contributed. Many are placed standing; but a hundred thousand crowns entitles to a chair. I observed a statue which had one of the feet under the chair; and was told that the reason was, that the benefactor honoured by it had contributed only ninety thousand crowns. The statues in the wards are now injurious by harbouring dust. From a regard to the health of patients, I wish to see plain white walls in hospitals, and no article of ornamental furniture introduced." [From *An Account of Lazarettos*, p. 57.]

Before the cantons, I will mention, what is not indeed any part of Switzerland, the little Republic of

GENEVA

In the prison, which was formerly the Bishop's palace, at my first visit, there were only five criminals; none of them in irons.

[1] I make an apology for being so minute in my description of prisons in England, and may I not make the same apology for the minuteness in my accounts of foreign prisons and hospitals. I should never have given myself the trouble of taking the dimensions of rooms, were it not that I hoped to give a clearer idea of the buildings, and that perhaps some hints might be derived for the improvement of our own.

Their allowance about sixpence a day: for which they have a pound of good bread, some soup, and half a pint of wine. They looked healthy. Here, as in the Swiss cantons, men and women are kept separate. For some years past, no capital punishment. If a criminal flies from justice, they call him in form three days; and after trial, execute him in effigy.

There seldom are any debtors. A creditor must allow his debtor in prison as much as felons have from the public: upon failure, the gaoler gives notice, and then discharges the prisoner. Besides, there are sumptuary laws in this State. And though the government is in general mild, there is a severe law against bankrupts, and insolvents; which renders incapable of all honours, and deprives of freedom, not only the debtor himself, but his children after him: except such of them as pay their quota of the debts.[1]

SWITZERLAND

In entering Switzerland from Geneva, a traveller will be surprised to meet frequently with a gallows on the road, if he be not informed that almost every *seigneurie* or bailiwick has a prison, and possesses the power of trying criminals, and capitally convicting them. I visited one of these prisons. It belonged to Mr. Baron de Prangins, and consisted of four rooms at the top of his castle.[2] It was empty.

In those of the cantons to which I went, felons have each a room to themselves, "that they may not," said the keepers, "tutor one another." None were in irons: they are kept in rooms more or less strong and lightsome, according to the crimes they are charged with. But the prisons are in general very strong. The rooms are numbered, and the keys marked with the same numbers. In most of them a German stove. The common allowance, sixpence a day. In several cantons

[1] I hoped to have found here no torture-chambers, but I had only the pleasure to hear that none had suffered in them these twenty-five years. They are thus restrained by the thirty-second article in the *Réglement de l'illustre Médiation pour la Pacification des troubles de la République de Genève*, published in 1738. "Les accusés et criminels ne pourront être appliqués à la Question ou Torture, que préalablement ils n'ayent été, par jugement définitif, condamnés à mort."

[2] I observed the same thing at the castle in the Isle of Gorgona in Italy, where there are two rooms at the top of the building for prisons. This is different from the ancient cruel mode of confining prisoners in pits and dungeons of castles.